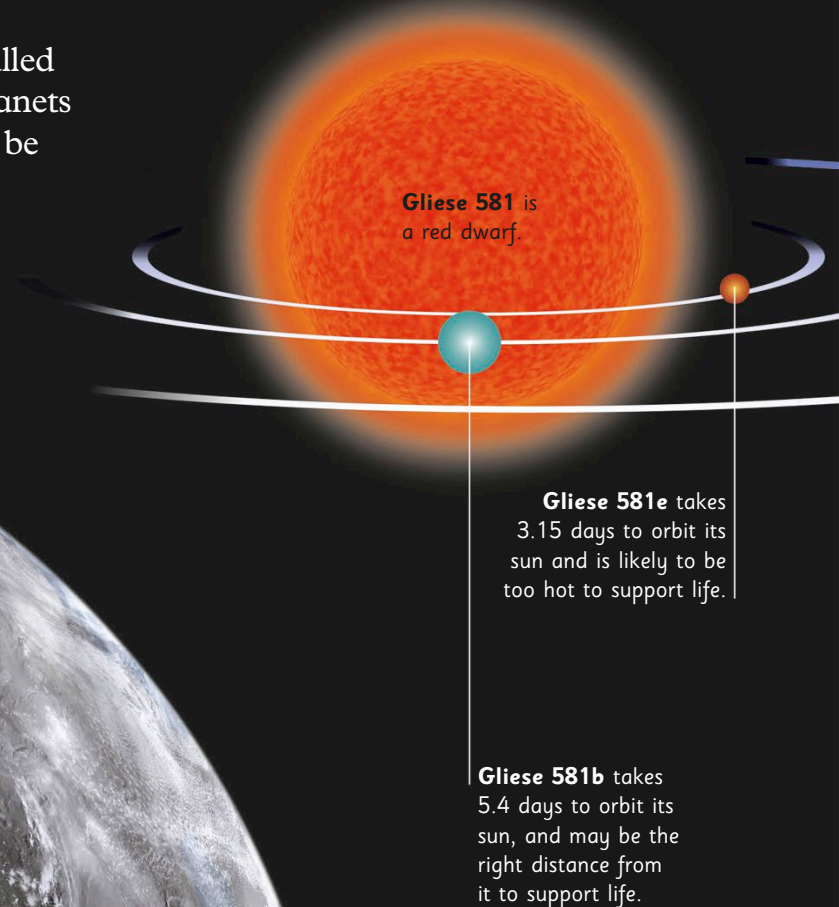


# Are there other Earths?

Astronomers know that there are planets outside our solar system. One day they hope to discover a planet that is capable of supporting life. The search has begun.

## An important discovery

About 20 light years away from us lies a star called Gliese 581. Astronomers have identified three planets orbiting Gliese. A planet too close to its star will be too hot for life, and the one too far away will be too cold. However, the one in the “Goldilocks”, or habitable, zone could be just right.



Gliese 581c may be rocky – or it may be composed of gas. Nobody is really sure.

## How right?

At first, experts thought Gliese 581c was in the Goldilocks zone, where surface temperatures would allow liquid water. Now however, they believe there may be a fourth, more distant planet.